TIME for KiDS

EDITION K–1
TEACHER'S GUIDE

VOL. 16, NOS. 25–28
MAY 2026

OCEANS

In this unit, students will learn about oceans and some of the animals that live in them. Then they'll research an ocean animal and make a model of it to add to a class diagram.

Essential Questions

- What are the five oceans? Why has so little of them been explored?
- What's a coral reef? Why is it important to protect coral reefs?
- How do you feel about sharks? What do shark species have in common?
- How do a sea turtle's parts help it to live on land and in water?

Correction: In our April 2026 issue *Amazing Places*, we misstated the location of Alexa's Elixer as Detroit, Michigan. The exhibit is located in and around Detroit Lakes, Minnesota.



Lesson 1: Deep Blue Sea ..... page 2

SUMMARY
Students will learn about the world's oceans and do a class activity to learn about ocean zones.

KEY TERMS
ocean, sea, zone



Lesson 2: Explore a Reef ..... page 4

SUMMARY
Students will learn about coral reefs, the animals that live in them, and how to protect the ocean habitat.

KEY TERMS
coexist, reef



Lesson 3: Ocean Hunters ..... page 6

SUMMARY
Students will learn about sharks and work with a partner to learn more about a shark species.

KEY TERMS
predator, species



Lesson 4: Turtle Time ..... page 8

SUMMARY
Students will learn about sea turtles and use a diagram to understand the parts that help them survive on land and in water.

KEY TERMS
algae, biologist

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DEEP BLUE SEA

CONTENT STANDARDS
Science (NGSS):
Earth's Systems

COMMON CORE STANDARDS (CCSS)
RI.1, RI.3, RI.7, SL.1, SL.4

MATERIALS & RESOURCES
Class set of *Deep Blue Sea*; paper plate map; class set of "Layers of the Ocean Bottle" worksheet, on p. 3 of this guide, and associated materials; Internet access

BEFORE READING
Remind students that in the last unit, they learned about the world and different places that are part of it. If you still have a paper plate map, take it out. Point out the different land masses that the class learned about. If you don't have it, you can refer to any map. Ask: What large areas on this map have we *not* learned about? Explain that today, and over the next few lessons, students will learn about the oceans and the animals in them. Challenge their knowledge with this month's Kahoot! quiz at *ti.me/OceansKahoot* before reading *Deep Blue Sea* as a class.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Name the five oceans. (p. 2)
- How can people explore the ocean? (pp. 2–3)
- In which zone do most ocean animals live? (p. 4)
- Why do you think most of the oceans have been unexplored? (pp. 2–4)

CLOSING ACTIVITIES

Return to the map you looked at in the beginning of the lesson. Call on volunteers to name each ocean. Which one is closest to where they live? Which ocean(s) have students been to?

Return to the last of the discussion questions. Explain that some parts of the oceans are extremely deep. Remind them that some parts (the midnight zone) are so deep that there's no sunlight, and there are few animals living there. Pass out copies of "Layers of the Ocean," on page 3 of this guide. Make the bottle as a class. Discuss what students see in the bottle before giving them time to color the image of the bottle on the worksheet and label its zones. When they're done, name and describe a marine animal. Have students point to the zone in which they think the animal lives. Ask questions such as "Can this animal be seen when snorkeling? When scuba diving?" They can use page 4 of the magazine to help.

Name _____ **Date** _____

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INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Layers of the Ocean

Read *Deep Blue Sea* (May 2026). As a class, make layers in the ocean bottle. Draw and label what you see.

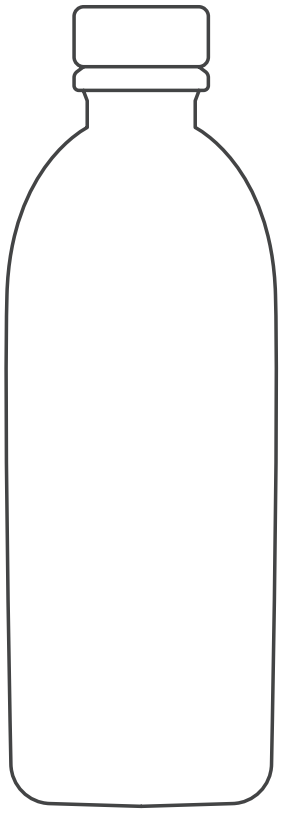
You Will Need

- a clear bottle or jar
- water
- blue food coloring
- oil
- funnel or measuring cup for pouring

Directions

1. Fill the bottle or jar halfway with water.
2. Add 10 drops of blue food coloring.
3. Fill the rest of the bottle with oil.
4. Close the lid tightly and shake the bottle well.
5. Observe the different layers. Draw and label them below.

YES—GETTY IMAGES



This is the _____ zone.

This is the _____ zone.

This is the _____ zone.

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EXPLORE A REEF

CONTENT STANDARDS
Science (NGSS):
Earth and Human Activity

COMMON CORE STANDARDS (CCSS)
RI.1, RI.2, RI.3, SL.1, K.MD.B.3

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

Class set of *Explore a Reef*; class set of "Coral Reef Count" worksheet, on p. 5 of this guide, crayons; Internet access

BEFORE READING

Show students the cover of *Explore a Reef* and call on volunteers to describe what they see. Read the cover text aloud, and tell students that they're looking at an image of a coral reef. Ask them to raise a hand if they've ever heard of a coral reef. Explain that a coral reef is an ocean habitat. Ask students what kinds of animals they think live in coral reefs. Invite them to share anything they know about coral reefs. Then tell them that *Finding Nemo* took place in the world's largest coral reef system, and see if they have any other information to add. Read *Explore a Reef* as a class.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- What's a coral reef? (p. 2)
- What kinds of animals live together in reefs? (pp. 2–4)
- What's notable about the Great Barrier Reef?? (p. 3)
- What does it mean to coexist? (p. 4)

CLOSING ACTIVITIES

To show students more of the Great Barrier Reef, you can use the Google Arts & Culture collection at *ti.me/BarrierReef*. Ask students to name some animals that live in coral reefs. Then pass out copies of "Coral Reef Count," on page 5 of this guide, and crayons. Read the directions aloud, and give students time to count and color. Have them compare their sheet with a partner's.

Bring the class back together and return to the section "Reefs Are Important," on page 3 of the magazine. Discuss what could happen if people don't take care of oceans and reefs. As a class, research some ways to protect coral reefs. You can use the worksheet "Reef Rescuers" (2019) at *ti.me/ReefRescuers* to have students make a pledge to protect coral. You can use these to make a coral reef bulletin board.

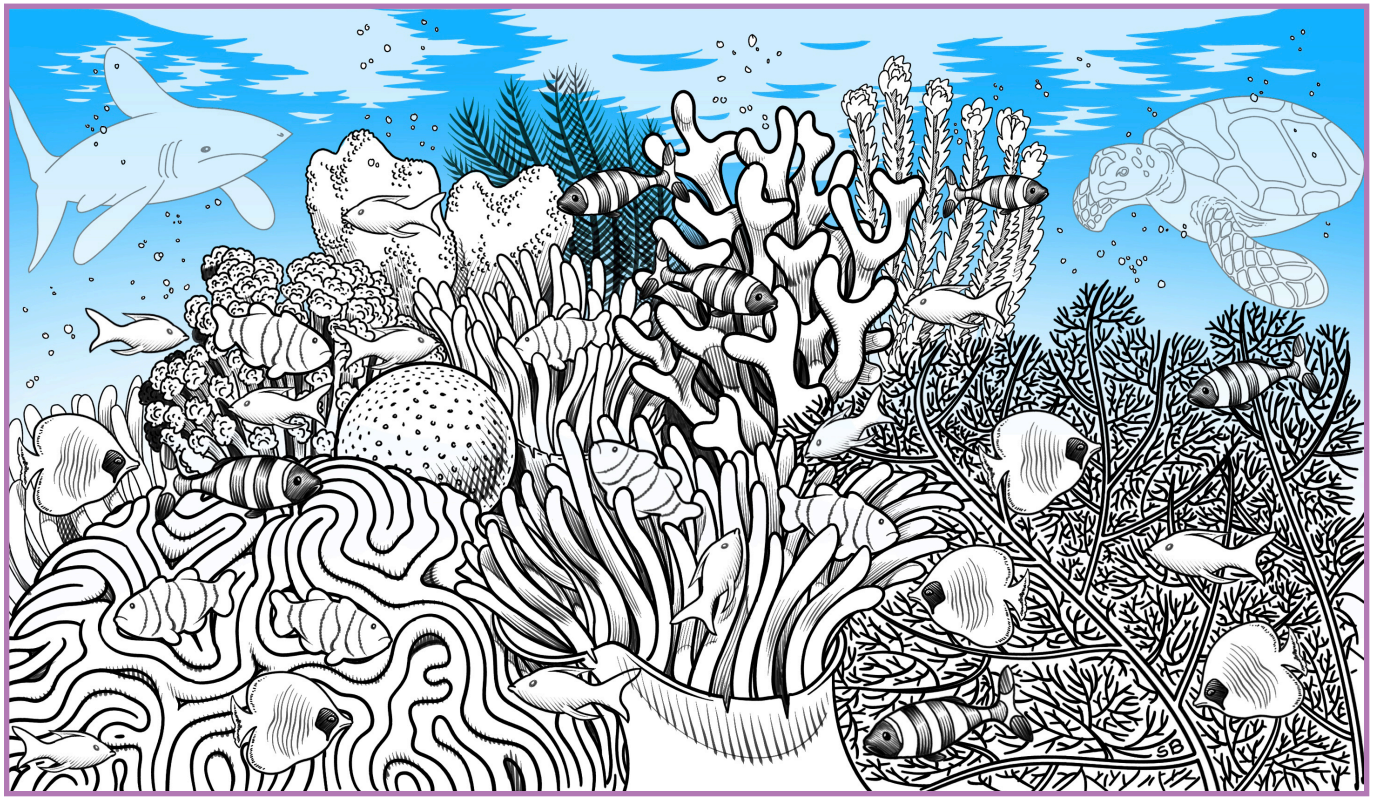
Name _____ **Date** _____

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INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Coral Reef Count

Read *Explore a Reef* (May 2026). Choose four crayons. Color each type of fish a different color. Then color in the graph.

STEPHEN BLUE FOR TIME FOR KIDS



	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
										
										
										
										

Count It! How many fish are there all together? _____

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OCEAN HUNTERS

CONTENT STANDARDS
Science (NGSS):
From Molecules to Organisms

COMMON CORE STANDARDS (CCSS)
RI.1, RI.2, RI.7, SL.1, SL.4, W.8

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

Class set of *Ocean Hunters*; class set of "Shark Facts" worksheet, on p. 7 of this guide; Internet access

BEFORE READING
Start the lesson by asking how students feel about sharks. Call on volunteers to explain why they feel the way they do. Talk about sharks that students have seen in movies and on TV. What are these characters like? Show the cover of *Ocean Hunters* and read the cover text aloud. Explain that, although sharks might look scary and may be portrayed as dangerous, they usually stay away from people. Tell students they'll be learning more about sharks today. Make a list of any questions they have about sharks, and see whether these are answered by the magazine.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- How many species of sharks are there? (p. 2)
- What do sharks eat? Are they carnivores, omnivores, or herbivores? (p. 2)
- Why do great white sharks leap out of the water? (p. 3)
- How do a blue shark's teeth help it eat? (p. 4)

CLOSING ACTIVITIES

Were students' questions answered in the text? If not, use this as a way to model how to research questions. Partner students up and tell them they'll be researching a species of shark to share with the class. Pass out a copy of "Shark Facts," on page 7 of this guide, to each pair. Read through all the things they'll need to find out about their species. Assign a shark species, or let pairs choose one. The web page *sharks.org/species* is a good place to start. Give partners time to fill out their worksheet. Then they can present what they learned to the class. Discuss what different species have in common.

Close the lesson by asking students how they feel about sharks after learning more about them. To extend the activity, have them turn their shark species into a character in a book, movie, or TV show. They should describe what their shark is like, and the other sea animals it interacts with.

Name _____ **Date** _____

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PARTNER WORK

Shark Facts

Read *Ocean Hunters* (May 2026). Then research a species of shark. Write and draw some facts below.

My shark species: _____

Shark tooth

Color the oceans where the species is found.



Label the ocean layer they live in.

Interesting Facts

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TURTLE TIME

CONTENT STANDARDS
Science (NGSS):
From Molecules to Organisms

COMMON CORE STANDARDS (CCSS)
RI.1, RI.2, RI.7, SL.1, SL.4

MATERIALS & RESOURCES

Class set of *Turtle Time*; class set of "Turtle Traits" worksheet, on p. 9 of this guide

BEFORE READING
Remind students that in the previous lesson, they learned about sharks. Tell them that today, they'll learn about another ocean animal. Have them guess which one. Give them the following hints: The animal made a guest appearance in the issue about coral reefs. The animal can be found both on land and in water. Once someone correctly guesses it's a sea turtle, show the class the cover of *Turtle Time* and read the cover text aloud. Ask students if they've ever seen a sea turtle, in real life, in a movie, or in a video. Invite students to share their experiences.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Where are sea turtles born? (p. 2)
- What's special about a sea turtle's eyes? (p. 3)
- What do you think the trash on page 3 looks like? Why is it a problem? (p. 3)
- How does the Sea Turtle Care Center help sea turtles? (p. 4)

CLOSING ACTIVITIES

Remind students that diagrams label the parts of something. What parts of a sea turtle can they name? Tell them that these are turtle's physical traits. Sea turtles have special parts that help them on land and in water. Pass out copies of "Turtle Traits," on page 9 of this guide, to learn more. Talk through the different parts of a sea turtle before having students fill in the blanks independently. Then challenge them to the Try It! section of the worksheet. Have them use the magazine for reference. Discuss how the turtle's parts help it survive on land and in water.

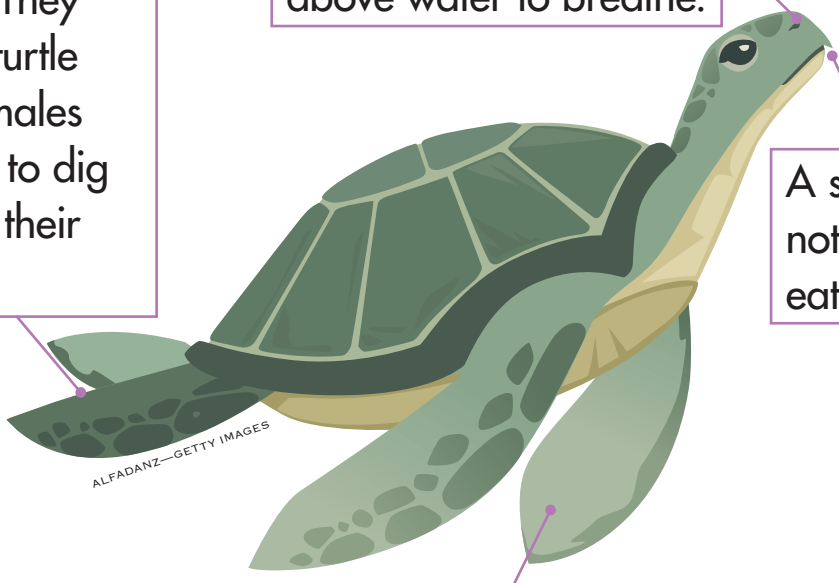
To extend the lesson, invite students and their partners to make a diagram of the sharks they researched in the previous lesson. Print out pictures of their sharks and have them label fins, gills, teeth, and other distinguishing features. Put partner groups together to compare and contrast sharks.

Name _____ **Date** _____

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INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Turtle Traits

Read *Turtle Time* (May 2026). Use the diagram below to fill in the blanks.



1. A sea turtle's beak is for _____.

2. A sea turtle's _____ help it breathe air.

3. The _____ flippers are used for steering and digging.

4. The front flippers help a sea turtle _____.

Try It! Add a detail about a sea turtle's eyes.

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Animals and Ocean Zones



BOHDAN BEVZ—ISTOCK/GETTY IMAGES PLUS

ELA STANDARD (CCSS)
Research and Writing Projects

LESSON OVERVIEW
Students will choose an ocean animal to research and make a model of. They will add it to a diagram of ocean zones.

MATERIALS

- Crafting materials such as clay, popsicle sticks, pipe cleaners, and pom poms
- Butcher paper or a large poster board
- Large index cards
- Images and/or books of ocean animals

Prep work

1. Separate a large piece of butcher paper or poster board into four horizontal bands. Draw a sun in the top band. The other three will represent the zones of the ocean that students have learned about.
2. Choose ocean animals that students will pick from. Number an index card for each student. Prepare research materials, as needed, and decide what level of research is right for your students. At minimum, have a book or an image for each animal. Prepare research and a model of a sea turtle to use as an example.
3. Decide what materials you want students to have access to for model making. Gather enough materials for each student.

Lesson flow

1. Start by showing the class the paper that will be used to represent the ocean zones. Review what the zones are, and what differentiates them. Bring out the bottle that was made in an earlier lesson. Have the class work together to color each zone. Turn it into a diagram by using index cards to label and describe each layer.
2. Tell students that they'll be filling out this ocean poster with models of animals that live in different zones. Show students your sea turtle model, as an example. Then have students pick out of a hat, or choose an animal from a given list that they'll make and learn more about.
3. Give students a picture of or a book about their animal. Ask them how much bigger or smaller than your sea turtle their animals might be. This will help them decide how large to make their model animal. Show students the materials from which they can create their animal. Provide ample time for students to build their sea creature.
4. When students are done crafting, bring the class back together to explain the research portion. At minimum, students should be able to identify the oceans and the ocean zone in which the animal lives. They should also be able to identify some interesting facts, like they did with their shark research.
5. Pass out numbered index cards. The number will correspond to the label for each animal on the poster. Ask students write the name of their animal on the top of the index card and to add facts to the lines.
6. Attach each animal model to the poster in the correct zone. Add a number to label each of them. Add the index cards around the poster for viewers to reference.

Discussion

Have the class take a look at the ocean diagram they created. Go through each zone, inviting students to tell their classmates about their animal. Then discuss which zone is home to most of the creatures, and why.

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GRADE K–1
2026–2027 EDITORIAL CALENDAR













September Bundle: Community

- Get to know the people and places that make up different types of communities.

October Bundle: Living Things

- Explore things that are growing, moving, and using energy all around us.

November/December Bundle: Math

- Find shapes and measurements nearby.

January Bundle: Health

- Learn about keeping clean and feeling good.

February/March Bundle: Transportation

- Take a tour of different ways to get around.

April Bundle: Environment

- Live greener with gardening, recycling, and composting.

May Bundle: Arts

- Discover different kinds of artists and the creations they make.

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ATTENTION, POSTMASTER AND SCHOOL SECRETARY:

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FIRM BUNDLE

DO NOT BREAK OPEN!

THIS PACKAGE GOES TO ONE TEACHER

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